IRANIAN AND MACEDONIAN INVASIONS

Continuous at-a-glance master • north-west frontier • evidence before legend

ACHAEMENID: longer incorporation, tribute, levies, Aramaic context

MACEDONIAN: short campaign, alliances, battles, garrisons and rapid fragmentation

MASTER ANSWER LINE

Limited territorial reach did not mean isolation: the invasions reworked a connected frontier through variable rule, local agency and selective long-term contacts.

01

TWO DISTINCT FRONTIER EPISODES

Achaemenid · Macedonian · bounded reach · local agency

Longer Achaemenid incorporation and Alexander's 327–325 BCE campaign are not one invasion.

Core space is Gandhara and the Indus-Punjab frontier, not the whole subcontinent.

Later Seleucids and Indo-Greeks are successor histories, not Alexander's occupation.

ANSWER LINE: two unequal frontier encounters produced limited conquest but durable selective contact.

02

SOURCE FIREWALL

Inscription · relief · Herodotus · later narrative

1 Behistun, DNa and XPh prove claimed imperial inclusion, not surveyed borders.

2 Persepolis imagery represents imperial order; coins show circulation before sovereignty.

3 Arrian, Curtius, Diodorus, Plutarch and Justin transmit lost sources through later genres.

METHOD: name source -> state proof -> add date, genre, unit or attribution limit.

03

CONNECTED FRONTIER MAP

Hindu Kush · Taxila · Punjab rivers · Makran

CLAIM — Approach: Iranian plateau -> Hindu Kush -> Kabul/Swat -> Gandhara/Taxila -> Indus.

EVIDENCE — Punjab: Hydaspes/Jhelum -> Acesines/Chenab -> Hydraotes/Ravi -> Hyphasis/Beas.

LIMIT — Return: lower Indus/Patala -> Nearchus by sea; Alexander through Gedrosia/Makran.

GEOGRAPHY: routes enabled movement, while terrain, rivers, supply and communities imposed friction.

04

CYRUS TO DARIUS TO XERXES

Cyrus caution · Darius · 518/516 BCE · Xerxes

Cyrus II is a possible eastern antecedent; a securely mapped Indian conquest is unproved.

Darius: Gandara at Behistun; Gandara and Hindush in DNa; Scylax voyage reported.

Xerxes continues eastern country claims and troop obligations; control remained variable.

CHRONOLOGY: Darius is firmest; the 518/516 BCE date is a convention, not a conquest charter.

05

ROYAL GEOGRAPHY AND HERODOTUS

DNa · Apadana · 360 talents · contingents

1 Naqsh-i Rustam and Persepolis place eastern peoples inside a royal world of ordered diversity.

2 Herodotus's twentieth district and 360 talents signal perceived wealth and extraction.

3 Indian/Gandarian contingents and possible later mercenary or allied service show varied obligation.

LIMIT: royal rhetoric, Greek genre and uncertain units forbid modern audit or census readings.

06

SATRAPY, ARAMAIC AND KHAROSHTHI

satrapy · local mediation · Aramaic · right-to-left

CLAIM — Provincial supervision could combine tribute, levies, routes and local intermediaries.

EVIDENCE — Imperial Aramaic supplies the strongest context for Kharoshthi's right-to-left structure.

LIMIT — Kharoshthi adapted a model to Indo-Aryan sounds; inventor and exact transmission remain unknown.

VERDICT: imperial obligation was real, daily control uneven, and script transfer selective.

07

CONTACTS WITHOUT PERSIANISATION

coins · weights · artisans · selective adaptation

Daric/sigloi and local coin forms reveal a monetary frontier, not one royal currency system.

Routes moved soldiers, merchants, scribes and artisans but existed before Achaemenid rule.

dipi/lipi and capital parallels are bounded comparisons, not proof of copied Mauryan institutions.

TRAP: reject both total Persianisation and total denial of specific Achaemenid links.

08

ALEXANDER'S EASTWARD ROUTE

327 BCE · Asvaka · Taxila · Hydaspes

1 327 BCE highland campaigns preceded the Indus; Aornos identification remains debated.

2 326 BCE: Ambhi at Taxila -> Hydaspes against Porus -> Chenab/Ravi -> Beas halt.

3 326–325 BCE: Jhelum fleet -> Indus descent -> Malloi -> Patala -> divided return.

SCALE: Alexander reached the Beas, not the Ganga plain, and did not conquer India.

09

HYDASPES: TERRAIN AND TACTICS

feint · upstream crossing · cavalry · elephants

CLAIM — Craterus remained opposite Porus while Alexander reportedly moved a selected force upstream.

EVIDENCE — Cavalry manoeuvre pressured the wings; elephants caused shock and could also disrupt formations.

LIMIT — Greek success was followed by Porus's restoration and enlargement as indirect rule.

SOURCE LIMIT: tactics, speeches, casualties and the Porus medallion remain textually mediated.

10

WHY ADVANCE STOPPED

fatigue · monsoon · logistics · Nanda reports

Years of campaigning, homesickness and replacement shortages weakened willingness.

Rivers, humidity, disease and supply distance raised the expected cost of further movement.

Resistance and reports of eastern armies/elephants sharpened risk; exact totals are rhetorical.

CAUSATION: a cumulative command-morale crisis, not Indian unity or one frightening number.

11

RESISTANCE, DESCENT AND RETURN

Malloi · Patala · Nearchus · Onesicritus

1 Malloi resistance seriously wounded Alexander and disproves smooth pacification.

2 Patala was a delta and fleet-preparation node; ancient channels and location require caution.

3 Nearchus and Onesicritus were participants, but their writings survive through later authors.

RETURN: route knowledge is firmer than marvels, exact losses or Alexander's motives in Makran.

12

ARRANGEMENTS AND FRAGMENTATION

Porus/Ambhi · satraps · garrisons · 323 BCE

CLAIM — Local rulers coexisted with officers such as Philip, Peithon and Eudemus in changing commands.

EVIDENCE — Greek-named settlements and garrisons held corridors rather than a pan-Indian civil state.

LIMIT — Alexander's death-triggered succession conflict, withdrawals and local reassertion.

DURABILITY TEST: a personal command network fragmented before institutional consolidation.

13

CONSEQUENCES WITH BOUNDARIES

Mauryan opening · route knowledge · settlements · Indo-Greeks

Fragmentation was one favourable condition for Chandragupta, not the cause of the Mauryan Empire.

Campaigns documented and intensified older routes and Greek geographical knowledge.

Mature Indo-Greek coinage and Gandhara art belong to later states, patrons and workshops.

THREE COLUMNS: immediate effect -> indirect opportunity -> later successor development.

14

COMPARISON AND ANSWER SPINE

duration · mechanism · evidence · qualified verdict

1 Achaemenid: longer, tribute/satrapal/scribal, contemporary inscriptions plus Herodotus.

2 Macedonian: shorter, military/geographical, detailed but later classical narratives.

3 Answer: define -> map -> sources -> chronology -> actors -> effects -> compare -> qualify.

FINAL VERDICT: bounded control, connected frontier and lasting but selective consequences.

END • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping native-width crops